

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Peter Cox

Address: Whitecroft 3 Manor Road Cheam SM2 7AG

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment:DM2025/01591 Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

I OBJECT to the proposal for the following reasons:

1. The Planning Statement page 3 reads : [A package of measures-including staggered prayer sessions, volunteer traffic marshals, on-site parking management, car sharing promotion].

Since this proposal requires all these measures to alleviate anticipated traffic congestion, it rather suggests a problem with its location from the outset. Also, the fact the traffic marshals are 'volunteers' could result in the double-whammy effect of less marshals / more drivers when it is cold and wet.

2. Planning Statement page 7 reads: While the area is predominantly residential in character, it is supported by a range of established social infrastructure, including St John's Church and Community Hall, many nursing homes in the area, and several educational institutions such as Avenue Primary Academy, Harris Academy Sutton and Overton Grange School within a short walking distance.

The above statement tends to illustrate the area is already full to capacity. I accept that moving the centre of worship from St John's Hall alleviates parking pressure around the St John's church (esp

on Fridays) but with the new centre only having 14 parking spaces, it will exacerbate the already strained on-street parking problem around Dorset Road.

3. Planning Statement page 7 reads: The site lies approximately 500 metres from Belmont Station, and access to and from the site is well served by the S2 & S4 bus routes, offering good access to local public transport

The above statement contradicts the pre-planning statement [Quote: the site has a low PTAL rating of 1a which means there is extremely poor access to this location by public transport]. Also, whilst public transport gets you to a venue, it is not always the case people's home are near bus stops at the start point, and with the state of the borough's pavements this adds to temptation to drive - especially in winter. Additionally, page 13 of the Planning statement acknowledges that 'elderly residents, families with children, and those with mobility challenges all of who are likely to drive to the centre'.

4. Planning Statement pages 13 / 14 touches on the 'need for accessible, locally based faith, cultural and community centre' in the Belmont Ward.'

Due to its location within the Borough as a whole, this centre will serve not only Belmont Ward, but also South Cheam, Sutton South, most of Sutton West, most of East Cheam, and most of Carshalton South Wards. Again, whilst I agree with its purpose, it is very likely this new centre will very soon outgrow itself and become unsustainable, resulting in St John's Hall also being used in tandem.

5. Planning Statement page 20 states the previous use as an ambulance station i.e. 'Noise associated with emergency operations' '24-hour operation potential' 'Blue-light vehicle movements'

Page 20 of the Planning Statements reads [Quote: This context sets a precedent for operational use]. It is unfair on the local community to suggest that, because they have had traffic and noise before, then future noise of a different kind should be acceptable.